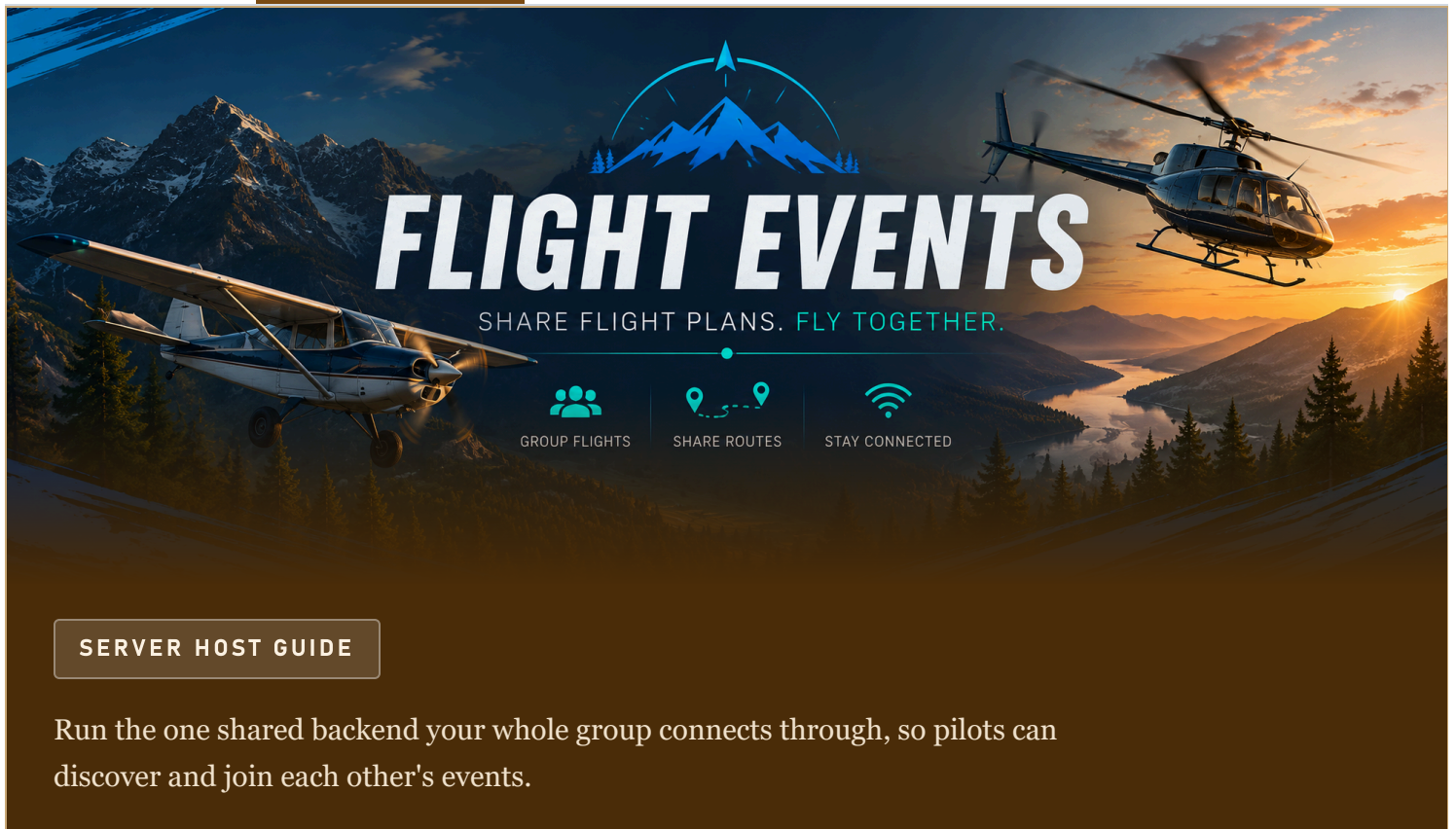




Run the one shared backend your whole group connects through, so pilots can discover and join each other's events.

The Flight Events server is the one shared piece of infrastructure your whole group connects through — it's what lets pilots discover and join each other's events. Only **one** person needs to run this (you), not every pilot.

You need:

- A Windows PC that can stay on and connected to the internet while people are using it
- **Node.js** installed — a free, standard tool for running JavaScript outside a browser. Download it from nodejs.org, choose the "LTS" version, and run the installer with default options.

STEP 1 — COPY THE SERVER FILES

Copy the `server` folder anywhere on your PC, e.g. `C:\FlightEventsServer` .

STEP 2 — RUN IT

- 1 Open a Command Prompt (search "cmd" in the Start menu).
- 2 Type `cd` (with a trailing space), then drag the `server` folder into the window, then press Enter. This changes into that folder.

- 3 Type:

```
node index.js
```

- 4 You should see:

```
Flight Events backend listening on port 4000 (all interfaces)
```

Leave this window open — closing it stops the server. Minimize it instead.

STEP 3 — MAKE IT REACHABLE FROM OUTSIDE YOUR NETWORK

By default this only works for pilots on your own home network. For pilots elsewhere to connect, you need to forward port `4000` to this PC on your router (search "port forwarding" plus your router's brand/model if you're not sure how). Once that's done, pilots connect using your public IP address (search "what is my IP" to find it) and port 4000, e.g.:

```
123.45.67.89:4000
```

Give that address to your pilots — they'll enter it in the add-on's Settings screen.

IMPORTANT

If your internet provider uses "CGNAT" (common on some home/mobile connections), port forwarding won't work at all, because your router doesn't actually have a public IP of its own. If forwarding doesn't seem to work no matter what you try, this is the most likely reason — in that case you'd need to host the

server somewhere else instead (a cheap cloud/VPS provider), which is beyond the scope of this guide.

OPTIONAL — CLEANING UP OLD/ABANDONED EVENTS

The server already auto-deletes events older than 24 hours on its own — you usually don't need to do anything. If you ever want to delete a specific event yourself (not just old ones):

- 1 Close the server (Ctrl+C in its window) if it's running.
- 2 Set an admin password before starting it. In the same Command Prompt, instead of Step 2 above, type:

```
set ADMIN_TOKEN=choose-a-password-here
node index.js
```

Do this every time you start the server if you want this feature available.

- 3 To delete a specific event, you'll need its ID (visible via `http://<your-address>:4000/events` in a browser) and a tool that can send a DELETE request with a custom header (e.g. `curl`, or ask someone technical for help) — this isn't something you can do from a regular web browser alone.

CHANGING THE PORT

If port 4000 is already used by something else on your PC, set a different one before starting:

```
set PORT=5000
node index.js
```

Remember to forward whatever port you choose instead, and tell pilots to use that port number.

TROUBLESHOOTING

→ Pilots get "this site can't provide a secure connection"

They (or their browser) are trying `https://` — this server only speaks plain `http://`. Make sure the address they use starts with `http://`, not `https://`.

→ Nothing happens when you double-click into the server folder / "node" isn't recognized

Node.js isn't installed, or you need to restart your Command Prompt (or PC) after installing it so Windows picks up the change.
